JAMES MITCHELL

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Experienced Staff Engineer with 10 years in backend systems and infrastructure, based in Glasgow. I've spent the last four years working on large-scale distributed systems at growing tech companies, focusing on reliability and performance. I'm comfortable diving deep into complex problems, mentoring junior engineers, and pushing through architectural challenges that need solving.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Staff Engineer

TechVault Solutions

techvault.io

Glasgow, United Kingdom

June 2022 - Present

Designed and implemented a microservices migration strategy that reduced API latency by 40% and improved system reliability to 99.99% uptime across 200+ services.

Established engineering standards and code review practices that increased team velocity by 35% while maintaining code quality metrics across fifteen engineers.

Built a comprehensive observability platform using Prometheus and Grafana, cutting mean time to resolution for production incidents from 4 hours to 25 minutes.

Mentored six junior and mid-level engineers through senior promotions, creating structured career development plans and regular feedback sessions.

Senior Software Engineer

Parallel Systems Ltd

parallel-systems.co

Glasgow, United Kingdom

March 2019 - May 2022

Led the redesign of our payment processing system to handle 10x transaction volume, implementing event sourcing and achieving zero data loss across 500 million daily transactions.

Reduced database query time by 65% through comprehensive indexing strategy and query optimization, improving end-user response times from 3 seconds to under 400ms.

Managed incident response for critical production outages, implementing automated alerting systems that decreased manual escalations by 80%.

Conducted architecture reviews and technical assessments for cross-functional teams, providing strategic recommendations that shaped our infrastructure roadmap.

Senior Backend Engineer

CloudBridge Technologies

cloudbridge.net

Edinburgh, United Kingdom

January 2016 - February 2019

Developed core API infrastructure handling 50 million requests daily, implementing rate limiting and caching strategies that improved system throughput by 200%.

Collaborated with DevOps to establish CI/CD pipelines using Jenkins and Kubernetes, reducing deployment time from 90 minutes to 8 minutes.

Optimized database performance by migrating from MongoDB to PostgreSQL for specific workloads, reducing storage costs by 45% while improving query performance.

Trained and onboarded twelve new backend engineers, creating comprehensive documentation and running weekly knowledge-sharing sessions.

EDUCATION

University of Edinburgh

MSc Computer Science

2014

University of Aberdeen

BSc Software Engineering

2013

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Java, Go, Python, SQL, bash scripting

Databases: PostgreSQL, MySQL, MongoDB, Redis

Cloud and Infrastructure: AWS, Kubernetes, Docker, Terraform

Messaging and Streaming: Kafka, RabbitMQ, Apache Flink

Monitoring and Logging: Prometheus, Grafana, ELK Stack, DataDog

API Design: REST, gRPC, OpenAPI, GraphQL

Version Control: Git, GitHub, GitLab

Architectural Patterns: Event sourcing, CQRS, microservices, distributed systems

Other: Load balancing, database optimization, incident management, system design